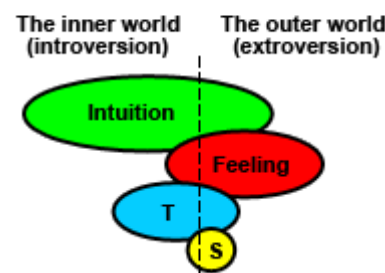


Cognitive Functions

Cognitive functions are the technical term for “Modes of processing information and making decisions based on your Myers-Briggs type.” Each type has four (out of a possible eight) cognitive functions, which they use in a specific order. Identifying which functions you use – and in what order – is the most accurate way to type yourself or anyone else.

INFJ Functions

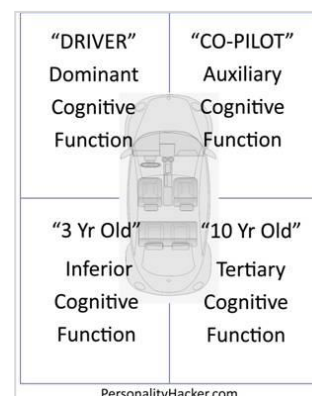
INFJ Primary Processes



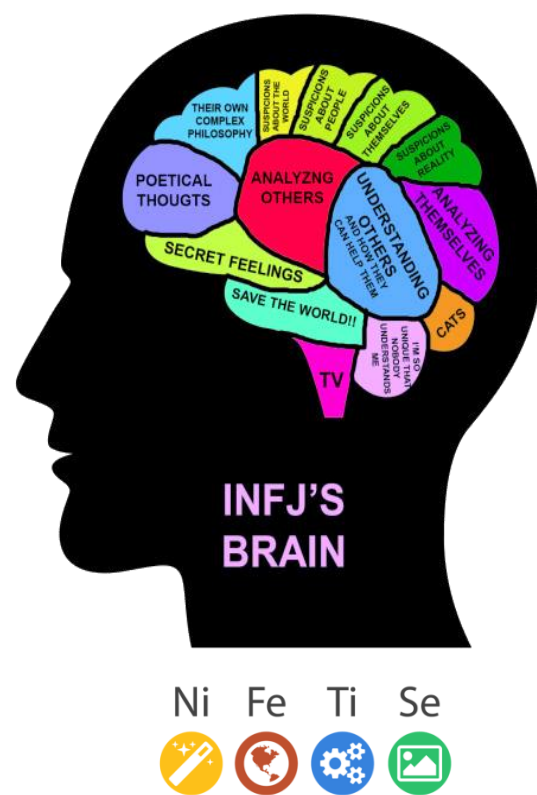
Role	Process	Snapshot
Leading “Driver”	Introverted Intuition	Foreseeing implications, transformations, and likely effects
Supportive “Co-Pilot”	Extroverted Feeling	Connecting and considering others and the group
Relief “10 year old”	Introverted Thinking	Analysing, categorising, and evaluating according the principles
Aspirational “3 year old”	Extroverted Sensing	Experiencing and acting in the immediate context

The analogy of a car is a useful model when thinking about cognitive functions. The first function is the ‘driver’ of the personality type and is the function from which perspective of all of the other functions follow. It provides the direction and speed. The second function is the ‘co-pilot’, which navigates around or through any difficulties encountered. The inferior, or **3 year old**, function attempts to distract both primary and secondary functions whereas the tertiary function, or ‘**10 year old**’, only distracts the current dominant function.

Understanding cognitive functions is imperative to understanding type. The four-letter dichotomies cannot possibly explain the complexity of our personalities – we are all thinkers, feelers, sensors and intuitives in various situations. The cognitive functions allow us to understand when we use each function and how it impacts our decision-making process.



The Cognitive Functions



Role	Process	Snapshot
Ne	Extroverted Intuition	How do concepts happen outside me?
Ni	Introverted Intuition	How do concepts happen within me?
Fe	Extroverted Feeling	How does this make others feel?
Fi	Introverted Feeling	Experiencing and acting in the immediate context.
Te	Extroverted Thinking	How does this logically affect things?
Ti	Introverted Thinking	How does this logically affect me?
Se	Extroverted Sensing	How is the environment outside me?
Si	Introverted Sensing	How is the environment inside me?

Conclusion

INFJ Confidants are dreamers whose relational genius and caring nature inspire others to achieve great things. INFJs are catalysts for growth in others.

Their greatest contribution is their ability to connect with the essence of others and to identify their strengths.

What is MBTI?

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI) is a tool that helps people gain insights about themselves and how they interact with others—and improve how they communicate, learn, and work.

Often referred to as a ‘personality test’, MBTI actually has less to do with one’s personality and everything to do with how their brain works from receiving and processing external information to communication preferences. These preferences are split into four pairs – I/E, S/N, F/T and J/P. Though everyone is unique and will have some traits of all 8 letters, people will often be more inclined towards one letter in each pair. By determining your preference in each group, and putting these four letters together, you get your personality **type code** – for you, this is **INFJ**.

INFJ – The Counsellor

What does that mean?

I ntroverted	Energised by quiet time alone
i ntuitive	Sees patterns and possibilities
F eeling	Prioritises people and emotions
J udging	Prefers structure and order

Exceedingly self-aware, INFJs are distinguished by both their complexity of character and the unusual range and depth of their talents. Strongly humanitarian in outlook, INFJs tend to be idealists, and because of their J preference for closure and completion, they are generally “doers” as well as dreamers. Decisive and strong-willed, they rarely use their energy for personal gain, acting with creativity, imagination, conviction and sensitivity not to create advantage, but to create balance. Egalitarianism and karma are very attractive ideas to INFJs.

INFJs are creative nurturers with a strong sense of personal integrity and a drive to help others realise their potential, as well as a talent for helping others with original solutions to their personal challenges. with other people. Guided by a deeply considered set of personal values, INFJs are intensely idealistic, and can clearly imagine a happier and more perfect future, and feels an intrinsic drive to do what they can to make the world a better place.



INFJs want a meaningful life and deep connections. They do not tend to share themselves freely but appreciate emotional intimacy with a select, committed few. Although their rich inner life can sometimes make them seem mysterious or private to others, they profoundly value authentic connections with people they trust. The Counsellor has a unique ability to intuit others’ emotions and motivations, and will often know how someone else is feeling before that person knows it himself. They trust their insights about others and have strong faith in their ability to read people. Although they are sensitive, they are also reserved; the INFJ is a private sort, and is selective about sharing intimate thoughts and feelings.

Strengths

- **Creative** – Using vivid imagination and a strong sense of compassion to resolve human challenges.
- **Insightful** – Seeing through dishonesty and disingenuous motives, INFJs see how people and events are connected, and are able to use that insight to get to the heart of the matter.
- **Inspiring and Convincing** – INFJs have a fluid, inspirational writing style that appeals to the inner idealist in their audience.
- **Decisive** – INFJs don’t just see the way things ought to be, they act on those insights.
- **Determined and Passionate** – When INFJs believe that something is important, they pursue that goal with conviction and energy, rocking the boat if necessary.
- **Altruistic** – INFJs have strong beliefs, and take action not to advance themselves, but to advance ideas that they truly believe will make the world a better place.
- **Excellent verbal and written communication skills**

Weaknesses

- **Sensitive** – highly vulnerable to criticism and conflict; questioning their motives is the quickest way to their bad side.
- **Extremely Private** – INFJs are extremely private when it comes to their personal lives. Trusting a new friend can be challenging for INFJs.
- **Perfectionistic** – INFJs are all but defined by their pursuit of ideals. While this is a wonderful quality in many ways, an ideal situation is not always possible.
- **Can Burn Out Easily** – Their passion, poor patience for routine maintenance, tendency to present themselves as an ideal, and extreme privacy tend to leave INFJs with few options for letting off steam. People with this personality type are likely to exhaust themselves in short order if they don’t find a way to balance their ideals with the realities of day-to-day living.
- **Has trouble with conflict**



Recognising the INFJ

INFJs often appear quiet, caring and sensitive, and may be found listening attentively to someone else's ideas or concerns. They are highly perceptive about people and want to help others achieve understanding. INFJs are not afraid of complex personal problems; in fact, they are quite complex themselves, and have a rich inner life that few are privy to. They reflect at length on issues of ethics, and feel things deeply. Because Counsellors initially appear so gentle and reserved, they may surprise others with their intensity when one of their values is threatened or called into question. Their calm exterior belies the complexity of their inner worlds.

Because INFJs are such complex people, they may be reluctant to engage with others who might not understand or appreciate them, and can thus be hard to get to know. Although they want to get along with others and support them in their goals, they are fiercely loyal to their own system of values and will not follow others down a path that does not feel authentic to them. When they sense that their values are not being respected, or when their intuition tells them that someone's intentions are not pure, they are likely to withdraw.



Career

INFJs have pretty tall demands when it comes to a satisfying work environment. Not only does this personality type need to be able to express their creativity and insight, INFJs need to know that what they are doing has meaning, helps people, leads to personal growth and, all the while, is in line with their values, principles and beliefs. INFJs are hardworking, trustworthy, and more than capable of handling their responsibilities and professional relationships.

As subordinates: INFJs are likely to chafe under hard-line rules, formal hierarchies and routine tasks; the more they feel their independence and input are valued, the happier they'll be.

As colleagues: INFJs are often seen as positive, eloquent and capable friends, able to identify others' motives and defuse conflicts and tension before anyone else even senses a disturbance. INFJs tend to prioritise harmony and cooperation over ruthless efficiency, encouraging a good, hardworking atmosphere and helping others when needed.

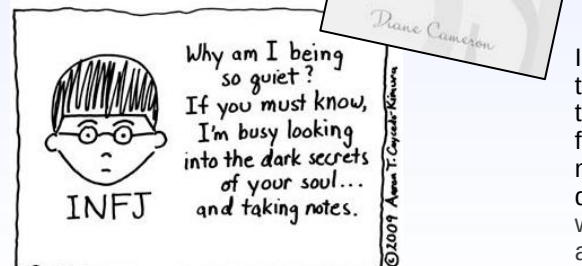
As managers: INFJs prefer to see their subordinates as equals, and working hard to inspire and motivate, not to crack the whip. However, their sense of equality means that they expect their subordinates to be as competent, motivated and reliable as they themselves. They have no tolerance for lapses in reliability or morality. But, so long as no such lapse occurs, INFJs will work tirelessly to ensure that their subordinates feel valued and happy.

Career Matches

- Counsellor
- Clergy
- Therapist
- Writer
- Psychiatrist
- Psychologist
- Social Worker
- Educational Consultant
- Child Care
- Child Development
- Teacher
- Musician
- Photographer
- Professor
- Librarian
- Artist
- Medical Doctor
- Alternative Medicine
- Consultant
- Designer
- Human Resources
- Trainer

Popular INFJ hobbies

- Writing
- Art appreciation
- Cultural events
- Reading
- Socialising in small, intimate settings
- Playing or listening to music



Relationships

INFJs define love in terms of emotional intimacy and shared values, yearning for authenticity and sincerity – in their activities, their romantic relationships, and their friendships. With a knack for seeing beyond others' facades and interpreting intent and compatibility quickly and easily, INFJs will go out of their way to seek out people who share their desire for authenticity, and out of their way to avoid those who don't.

Unlikely to go for friendships of circumstance, like workplace social circles, INFJs seek out people who share their passions, interests and ideologies. INFJs make loyal and supportive companions, who encourage growth and life-enriching experiences with warmth, excitement and care. As trust grows, they will share more of what lies beneath the surface. For INFJs, quality trumps quantity every time, and over the years they will likely end up with just a few true friendships, built on a richness of mutual understanding that forges an indelible link between them.

Kindred spirits:

ISFJ, INFP, ENFJ

Intriguing differences:

ISFP, INTP, INTJ, ENFP

ISTP, ESTP, ESTJ and ESFP types present the most potential for personality, but also the best opportunities for growth due to their fundamentally different values and motivations. But because they are so different, their strengths are the INFJ's weaknesses, and if they are able to develop a relationship, they can learn a tremendous amount from each other.



Burnout

INFJs often become burnt out or overwhelmed if:

- they have neglected their own needs for a prolonged amount of time.
- they feel like they aren't living up to their own expectations, and are somehow failing to accomplish their purpose.

The INFJ who is suffering from burn out is often very different from their normal selves. They are anxious, and might even be pushy towards those around them. They may become self-destructive, much more reckless, and less compassionate than usual.

The INFJ needs to recharge their batteries, and spend some time tending to their own needs in order to mend.

Change

INFJs often do not mind change as long as this change is their own doing. They dislike living a boring life, but want to be able to prepare themselves for what is to come. They may come to realise that change is an inevitable part of life, but they honestly do not enjoy it.

Small distracting changes can be interesting to the INFJ, but any large changes make them unhappy.



INFJ Stressors



Famous INFJs

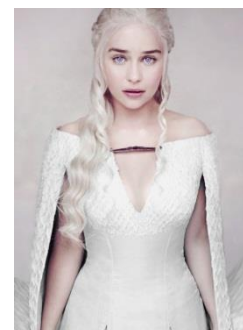
- Martin Van Buren, *American President*
- Chaucer, *Poet*
- Robert Burns, *Poet*
- Shirley Temple Black, *Actress*
- Tom Selleck, *Actor*
- Billy Crystal, *Actor, Comedian*
- Nelson Mandela, *President of South Africa*

Fictional INFJs

- Luke Skywalker, *Star Wars*
- Jane Eyre, *Jane Eyre (Novel)*
- Lisa Simpson, *The Simpsons*
- Tinman, *The Wizard of Oz*
- Kermit the Frog, *The Muppets*
- Frodo Baggins, *Lord of the Rings*
- Jack O'Neill, *Stargate*

Your character matches:

Game of Thrones:



Daenerys Targaryen
Mother of Dragons

Disney:



Elsa
Frozen

Prince Charming
Cinderella

What makes INFJs happy?

- Feeling valued and important to others.
- Knowing that someone actually cares about their feelings and wants them to be happy.
- Knowing that they can be themselves around their loved ones; but also feeling like they can provide a safe haven for the people that they care about.
- Exploring their own inner world and being able to get lost in it.
- Simple (and quiet) surprises that show them they are loved.
- Alone time.
- Being able to serve a greater and very real purpose in life.

